

Tsz Chun CHEUNG, Andy

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Education

Cornell University

Sep 2025 – May 2027

Master of Science in Applied Economics and Management

Ithaca, United States

- **Relevant Courses:** Production Economics, Causal Inference, Applied Econometrics, Empirical Methods for Applied Economists

Hong Kong University of Science and Technology

Sep 2021 – May 2025

Bachelor of Science in Economics and Finance (First Class Honors)

Clear Water Bay, Hong Kong

- **GPA:** 3.78 | **Honor:** Dean's List, University's Scholarship Scheme for Continuing Undergraduate Students
- **Relevant Courses:** Intermediate Microeconomics, Intermediate Macroeconomics, Econometrics, Multivariable Calculus, Linear Algebra, Mathematical Analysis, Monetary Economics, Urban and Environmental Economics, Intermediate Investment, Derivative Securities, Fixed Income Securities, Machine Learning for Economic and Financial Analysis

Work Experiences

Hong Kong Monetary Authority

Jun 2024 – Aug 2024

Summer Intern, Economic Research Division

Central, Hong Kong

- Conducted a research project on Chinese Housing Market Sentiment under supervision of an Economist, involving:
 - Developed a text mining model using prompt engineering and machines learning metrics with the in-house LLM
 - Processed and filtered nearly 200,000 Weibo posts to create daily sentiment index for Chinese housing market from 2021 to present using the designed model
 - Employed time series analysis, including Granger causality tests, to demonstrate the index's predictive power on the floor space sold growth in China
- Assisted an Assistant Economist with data surveillance and analysis of China's pension system:
 - Updated China's pension asset allocation data via Wind Terminal
 - Conducted research on the asset allocation of pension fund, identifying low investment levels in Hong Kong equities
 - Explored potential policy implications for stimulating pension fund investment overseas

Foresight Fund Management Co., Ltd

Jun 2023 – July 2023

Institutional Service Intern, Industry Research

Shanghai, China

- Conducted comprehensive industry research on the AIGC value chain, analyzing key players (e.g., Nvidia, Microsoft)
- Analyzed 30+ research reports, financial statements, and market data (e.g., size, share) across diverse AIGC sectors
- Developed a comprehensive AIGC industry profile through SWOT analysis
- Presented research findings to institutional clients, earning high commendation within the department

Research Experiences

HKUST Undergraduate Research Opportunity Project

Feb 2023 – May 2024

Undergraduate Research Assistant

Clear Water Bay, Hong Kong

- Participated in the research project on “Measuring Product Market Competition” and “Dissecting ESG shocks”
- Helped organize large datasets and ran preliminary statistical analyses on the cleaned-up data using Python
- Backtracked and classified ESG incidents based on relatively little information

Research Output

Sentiment and Housing Policy Effectiveness in China: Evidence from a GPT-Driven Text Mining Approach

Sep 2024 – May 2025

Advisor: Prof. Lu Yang

Bachelor Honor Thesis

- **Abstract:** This study investigates how public sentiment affects housing market policy effectiveness in China by introducing two methodological innovations. Firstly, it develops a GPT-driven text mining model to construct a housing market sentiment index from Weibo posts, achieving over 80% classification accuracy while reducing technical barriers. Secondly, it employs a smooth transition local projection method to examine how policy transmission varies across sentiment growth and dispersion regimes. Using monthly data from 2019 to 2024, analysis reveals contractionary mortgage rate policies yield significantly different outcomes. During positive sentiment growth, a 100 basis point increase in mortgage rate leads to a 0.35 percentage point increase in housing price return after eight months. Similarly, during high sentiment dispersion, a 100 basis point increase in mortgage rate leads to a 0.26 percentage point increase in housing price return. Conversely, policies are effective during negative sentiment growth or low dispersion, with same policy reducing housing price return by 0.87 and 0.55 percentage point respectively. These differential effects become statistically significant 7-9 months after implementation and are robust. Findings suggest policymakers should consider sentiment dynamics, as conventional policies may be counterproductive under optimistic growth or high disagreement.

- **Keywords:** Text Mining, Sentiment Analysis, Housing Market Policy Effectiveness, Local Projection, Sentiment Dispersion
- **Award:** Honor Thesis Award Gold Medal

Prediction of P2P Lending Default Using Machine Learning Methods

Sep 2023 – Dec 2023

Advisor: Prof. Ng Chi Yung

Bachelor Graduation Thesis

- **Abstract:** This study investigates machine learning's efficiency in predicting borrower default risk compared to traditional methods using pre-loan auction data. Logistic Regression, Random Forest, and Extreme Gradient Boosting Model were developed and optimized for recall using Bondora's P2P lending dataset. The random forest model achieved 97% recall, outperforming Bondora's existing model, highlighting the potential of machine learning in enhancing risk prediction and promoting sustainable lending practices.
- **Keywords:** Machine Learning, Logistic Regression, Random Forest, Extreme Gradient Boosting, P2P Lending, Default Risk

Activities

J.P. Morgan Private Bank Challenge

Mar 2023 – Apr 2023

Member

Hong Kong

- Conducted research on over 100 different equity and fixed-income assets using Refinitiv Eikon
- Utilized Markowitz Model to construct a short-run asset portfolio consisted of selected equity and fixed-income assets
- Designed a strategic asset allocation with total value up to US\$225 million for a virtual high-net-worth client

Skills

Programming & Analytics: Python, R, Stata

Productivity & Dev Tools: VS Code, LaTeX, Microsoft Office

Financial Data Terminals: Bloomberg, Refinitiv Eikon, Wind Terminal, S&P Capital IQ Pro

Languages: Mandarin (Native), English (Fluent, TOEFL: 110), Cantonese (Basic)